

Area of Study 5: Programme Music 1820–1910

Outline	Learners should study the development during the Romantic period of instrumental concert music that communicates a narrative or a non-musical idea: • study examples in depth of music for orchestral, chamber or solo performance from the period of study, using live performances, recordings and scores as appropriate • use attentive listening and contextual knowledge to analyse, evaluate and make critical judgements about the repertoire • use technical vocabulary to communicate a sophisticated understanding of romantic programme music and its context.
Focus for learning	Learners should analyse, explain and compare developments in styles of programme music, including: • concert overture • symphonic poem • programme symphony • solo works • works communicating an awareness of national identity. Learners should study and understand how musicians use musical elements, including: • harmony and tonality, e.g. expressive effects of dissonance, chords and modulation • integrating structural principles and expressive freedom, e.g. melodic writing, rhythm, adaptations of sonata form • instrumental resources, e.g. expansion of the orchestra, improvements in piano technology, instrumental technique, virtuoso soloists, the conductor • development of dynamics, expression, articulation, complex textures, dramatic contrast and other effects. Learners should study and understand the conditions and context in which programme music was created and performed, including: • the Romantic movement in the arts, e.g. Goethe, English poets, Gothic, rediscovery of Shakespeare • influence of opera on concert music • technological advances, e.g. valved brass, piano making • audience, e.g. growth of wealthy middle class, industrialisation, railway travel • transmission of music to a wider audience in Europe and the United States of America, growth of orchestras and public concerts • working conditions for musicians.
Prescribed works	No prescribed works for this Area of Study.
Suggested repertoire	A list of suggested repertoire is provided (see appendix 5e).